

FACULTY COMPOSITION & COMPENSATION

November 2019



GARIKAI CAMPBELL
Provost



*Explore. Question. Discover what is you and not-you.
You have the opportunity to take different classes ...
To join clubs. To attend talks and shows and events.
To try on different perspectives ...
[And as] you try them on, you will come to understand them better.*

...

*You are a model in this world, whether you intend to be or not.
Others will see you and hear you, and perhaps behave similarly.
You can be what you want to see in this world.
What do you choose to be?
What do you choose to cultivate in this world,
on our campus, and in the larger community?*

EVELYN CHIANG
Associate Professor of Psychology
UNCA Opening Convocation
August 2019

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PREFACE

This report represents an initial attempt to understand who our faculty are, a bit about some of the ways we compensate faculty, and an even smaller view of the faculty's teaching responsibilities. This particular report focuses mostly on *full-time faculty* and is only a snapshot in time—*Fall 2019*.

Notably, this report does not include many details on adjuncts, and does not include the “writer-in-residence” in the count. The report does not include several faculty who are on leave (unpaid, FMLA, Fulbright, or other such leaves) or are in administrative positions of a type that places them outside of academic affairs in a substantial way. Nor are the several faculty on phased retirement included in the data presented here. Finally, it is important to note that the academic enterprise is also incredibly well-supported by many staff as well. This report does not reflect their important contributions.

The hope is to, at some point, be able to include in future reports: data that show shifts over time, more information about adjunct faculty and academic affairs staff, more details on how faculty teaching intersects various elements of our curriculum, and data that capture the work of the staff that contributes to the excellence of our academic programs. I am hopeful that over time, we will be able to produce and share such reports regularly.

One of the challenges in producing this report was accurately accounting for and categorizing the data. Many faculty have unique circumstances or are in transition at some particular moment. Moreover, the data used here are in multiple locations with limited ability to easily stitch these data together. This is not atypical, but it means that we still have work to do to improve our ability to produce these kinds of reports accurately and quickly. Eventually, I hope that we can improve the data governance and infrastructure so that tracking and using this data is much easier moving forward.

I am grateful for the work of IREP and the Registrar's Office — Cale Burrell, Lynne Horgan, Jeff Konz, Peter Lewis, Deaver Trawick and Amanda Werts are those I know, but there may very well have been others from those offices as well. I am also grateful for the good feedback and advice of Brian Butler, Melissa Himelein, Herman Holt, and Wiebke Strehl in organizing some of these data.

Please note that this document is intended to be an internal document and is not intended to be copied, shared or distributed. All questions, errors, or concerns can be addressed to the Provost.

FALL 2019 FACULTY COMPOSITION: DEMOGRAPHICS

The number of faculty in much of the data presented here is 223. This represents the headcount of full-time faculty in Fall 2019. The preface indicated categories of faculty who are mostly NOT included, but I will point out here that the visiting faculty ARE included in this number (at the appropriate rank). The standard teaching load at UNCA is of course 24 credit hours (most often taught as eight 3-credit courses or six 4-credit courses). But, for a variety of reasons, not all faculty teach the full complement of 24 credit hours. These reasons include such factors as faculty going on *Professional Development Leaves* (PDLs)—opportunities for faculty to engage more fully in their research or other professionally relevant work; being granted *Reassigned Time* (RT) for particular service to the University, most notably, for example, being the chair of a department; or being bought out by a grant, being an endowed professor, or resourced by some other outside funds to engage in particular work.

In some cases these opportunities are “funded” by some (additional) source that has been identified, and in other cases, the institution simply bears the cost of these opportunities. We know, for example, that being the chair of a department has very real and weighty demands on faculty's time, particularly for larger, more complicated departments. The RT the department chairs receive is not something that we are given extra funds by the state to support (nor is it accounted for in “faculty productivity” as assessed by the state); currently, we must simply find ways to cover those costs in our existing budget.

In the data presented below, there are five ranks of faculty: lecturer (LECT), senior lecturer (SENL), assistant professor (ASSI), associate professor (ASSO), and full professor (FULL). There are two tenure-statuses reported—tenure-track or tenured (TT/T) or non-tenure track (NTT). In the future, I would like to break down the TT/T category into three further categories—pre-tenure, pre-reappointment; pre-tenure, post-reappointment; and tenured. (Note, here is a primary example illustrating that it isn't that we don't have this data, but rather that the data are not captured and tracked in a way that allows for easy reporting.)

NUMBER & PERCENTAGE OF FACULTY: BY RANK AND TYPE

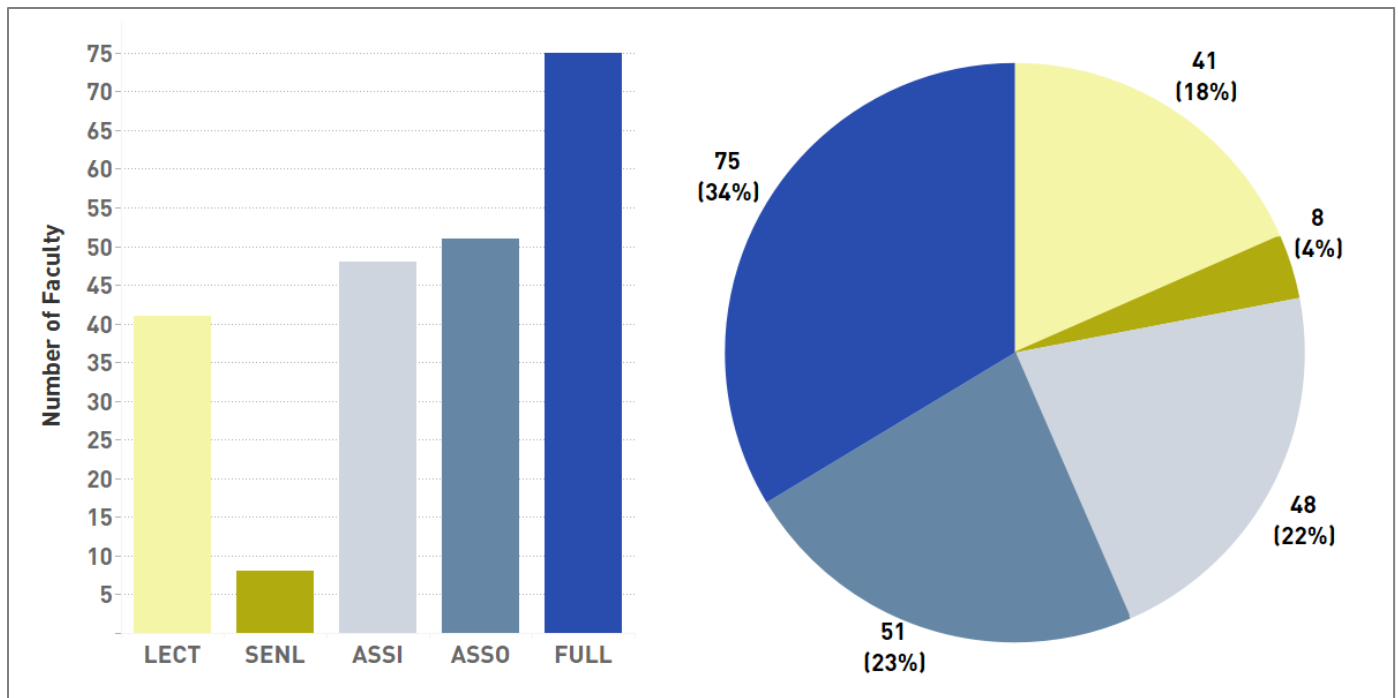


Fig 1. Number and percentage of the 223 full-time faculty active for Fall 2019 by rank. (Note: these are two views of the same data.)

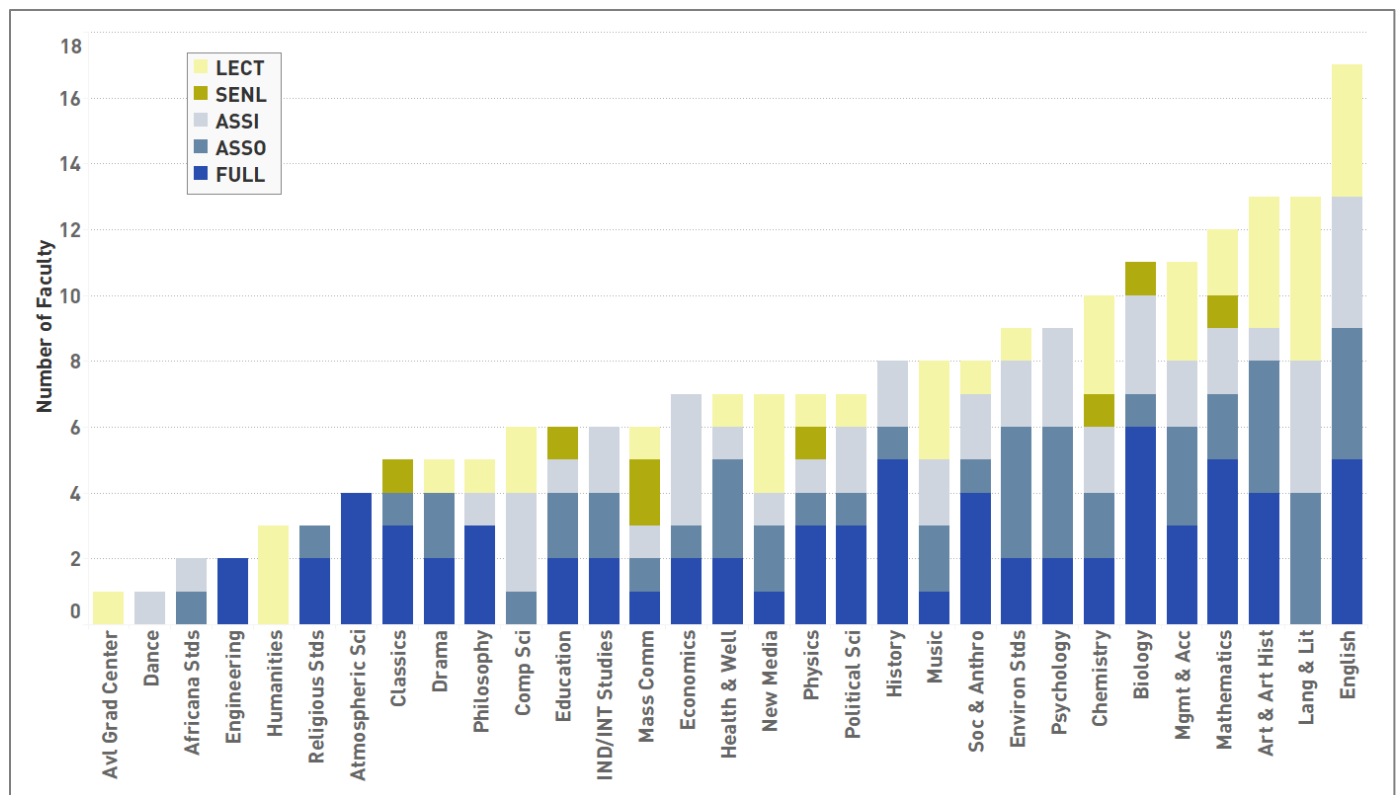


Fig 2. Number of faculty by rank and department.

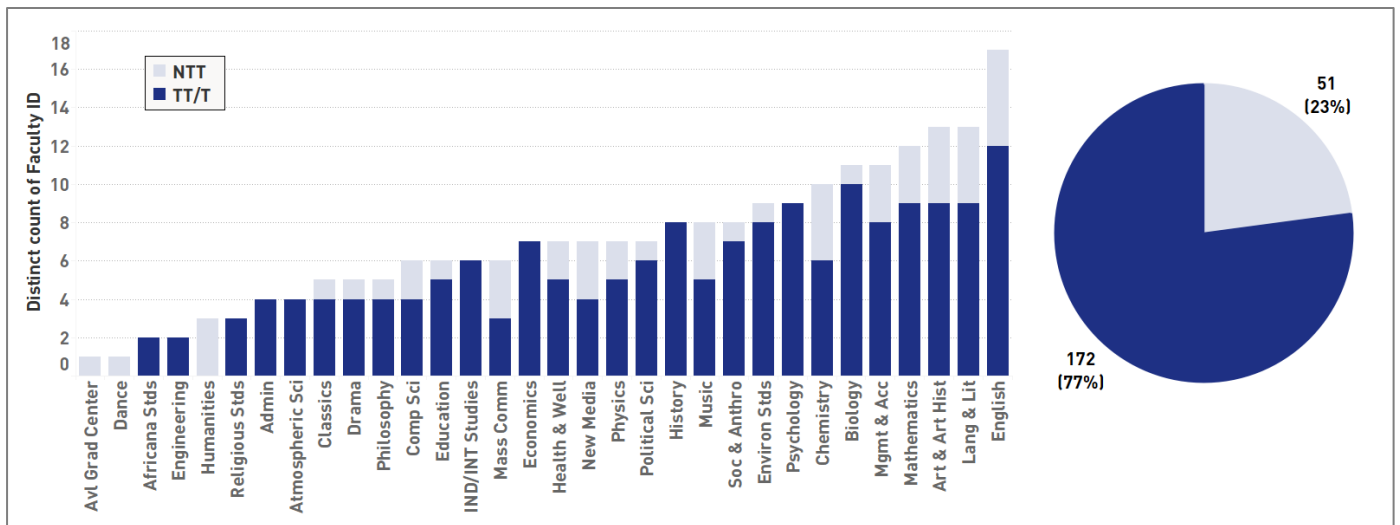


Fig 3. Number of faculty by tenure-track status and department.

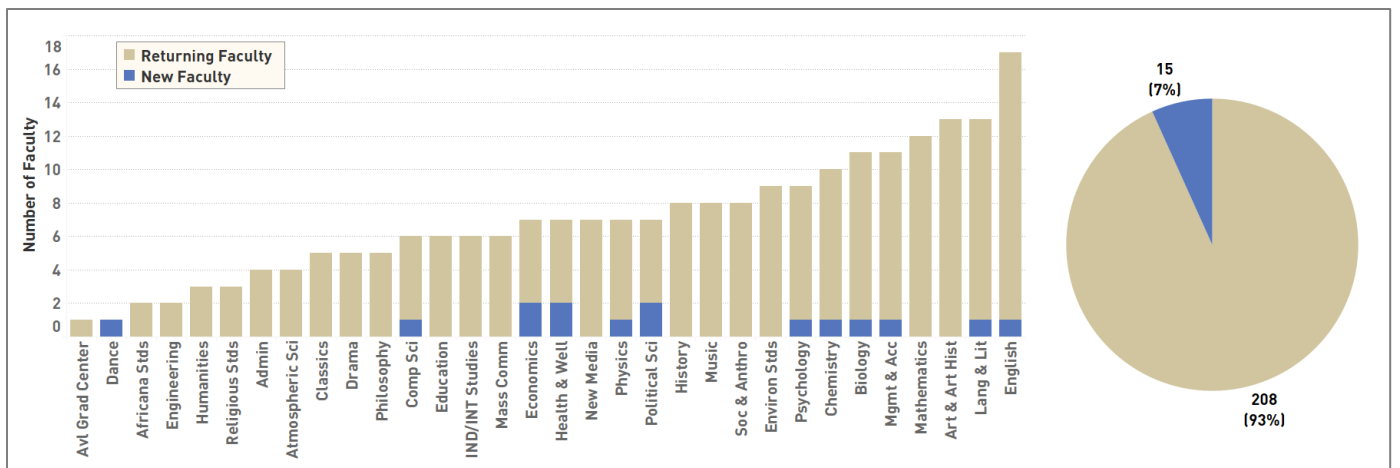


Fig 4. Number of new faculty (for this 2019–2020 academic year) by department.

Part of the impact of reassigned time is that there are very distinct measures related to the “count” of faculty—you have *headcount*, perhaps the easiest of these measures. You also have *teaching full time equivalent* (tFTE), essentially the fraction of 24 credit hours that a faculty member teaches. There is also something which I would call *salary full time equivalent* (sFTE), which is the fraction of one’s base salary a faculty member earns. If, for example, one were to teach 16 credits hours but receive a full salary, that faculty member’s *sFTE* would be 1 (matching the *headcount*), but their *tFTE* would be 16/24 or 0.67.

Looking at these various “counts” of faculty can be instructive. Outside of phased retirement, there aren’t any substantial ways in which UNCA faculty members receive a smaller fraction of their base salary. There are, however, stipends that faculty receive for various services. As a result, we do not discuss *sFTE* so much as discuss these stipends in the second part of this report. Similarly, ideas related to *tFTE* are discussed in the third section of this report.

FACULTY DIVERSITY: RACE & GENDER

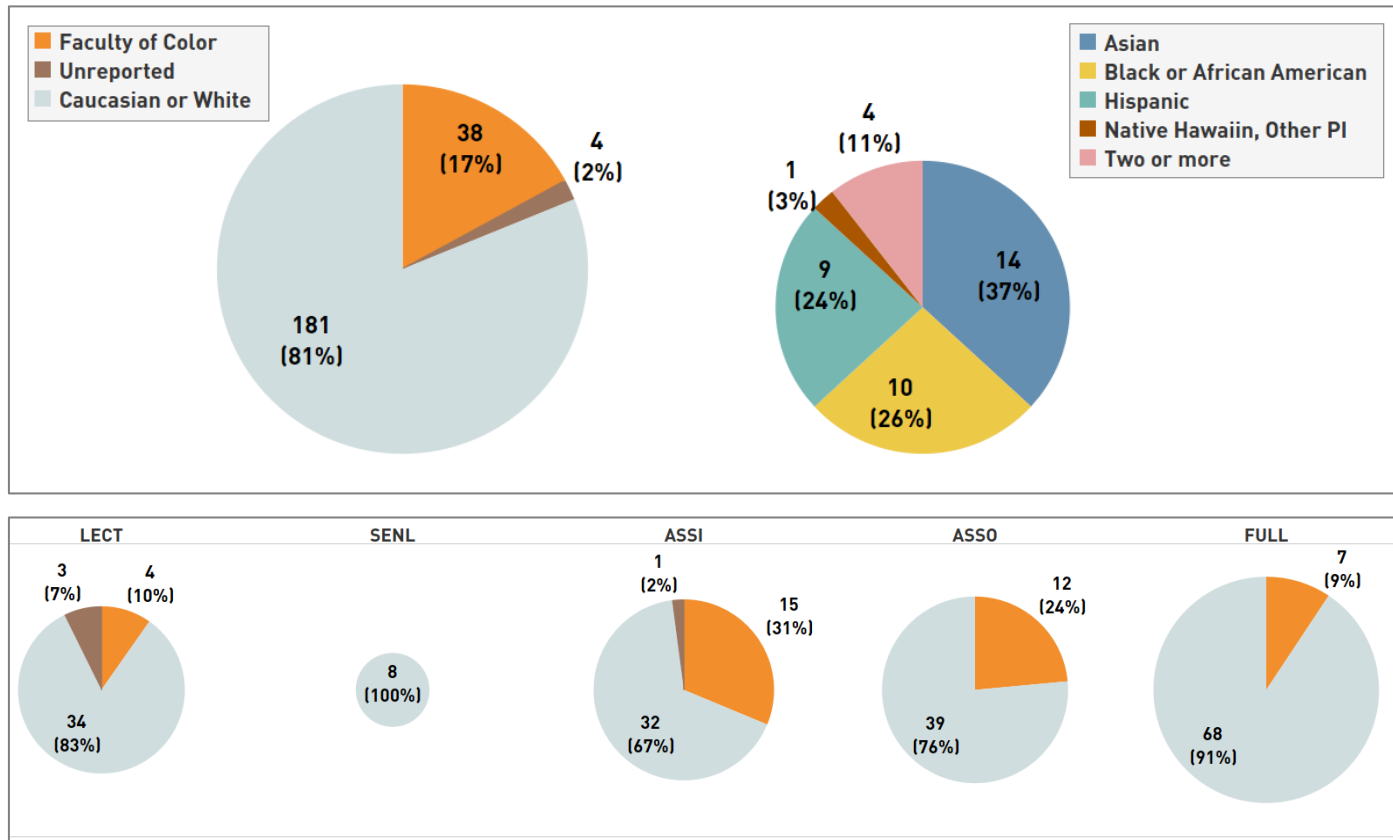
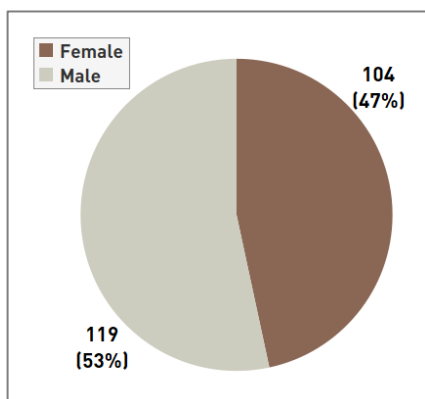


Fig 5. Number and percentage of faculty by larger racial categories (faculty of color, race unreported, and white faculty), breaking out the faculty of color by race; and number and percentage of faculty by larger racial categories by rank.

The percentage of faculty of color places us approximately 12th among the 17 UNC system institutions. Unsurprisingly, the HBCUs in the system have over 60% faculty of color, followed by Eastern Carolina University at about 30% and several others, including UNC Chapel Hill, NC State, UNC Charlotte and UNC Greensboro, UNC Pembroke, each at about 23%.

Our students continue to grow in diversity, with the number of students who identified as students of color going from about 15% in 2015 to just over 20% in 2019. Furthermore, a recent enrollment report suggests that as many as 1/3 of our applicant pool identifies as students of color. It is even more critical, then, for us to be attentive to the diversity of our instructional staff across all ranks, but certainly among our tenured faculty.



The gender distribution of our faculty looks to be fairly even, with one notable exception, and that is at the rank of full professor. It may be that this is a holdover from a number of factors that produced a more male-dominant older faculty. Or, it may be the result of some barriers to tenure and promotion experienced inequitably by women, and propagating through the system, culminating in a more pronounced issue at the rank of full professor.

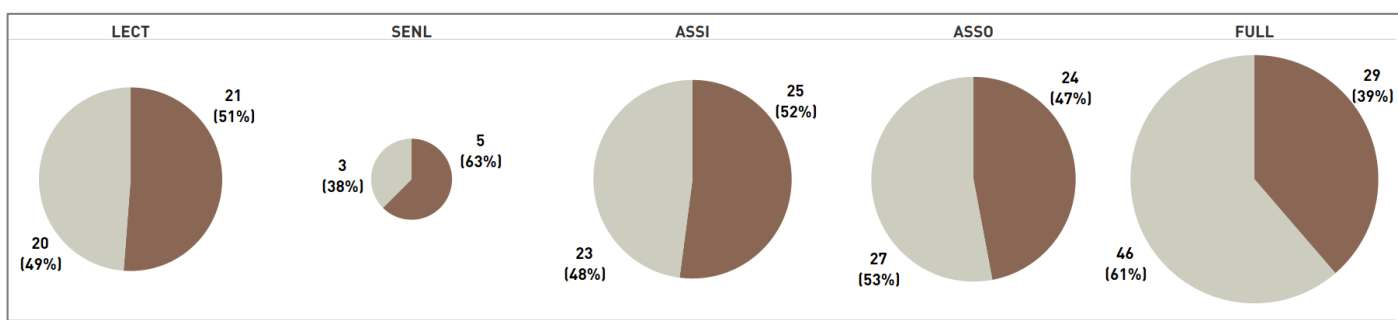


Fig 6. Number and percentage of faculty by gender, of all faculty, and then by rank.

At this point, it is unclear and anything stated is merely speculation. But, this is one observation that warrants further investigation. Otherwise, it appears to me that, in the cases where there are significant numbers of faculty, we are a well-balanced faculty with respect to gender.

FACULTY “AGE/EXPERIENCE”: TIME IN RANK

Because assistant faculty are generally promoted to associate faculty or not renewed by year 7 and because the senior lecturer position has not been in existence very long, we only share data about time in rank for lecturers, associate professors and full professors.

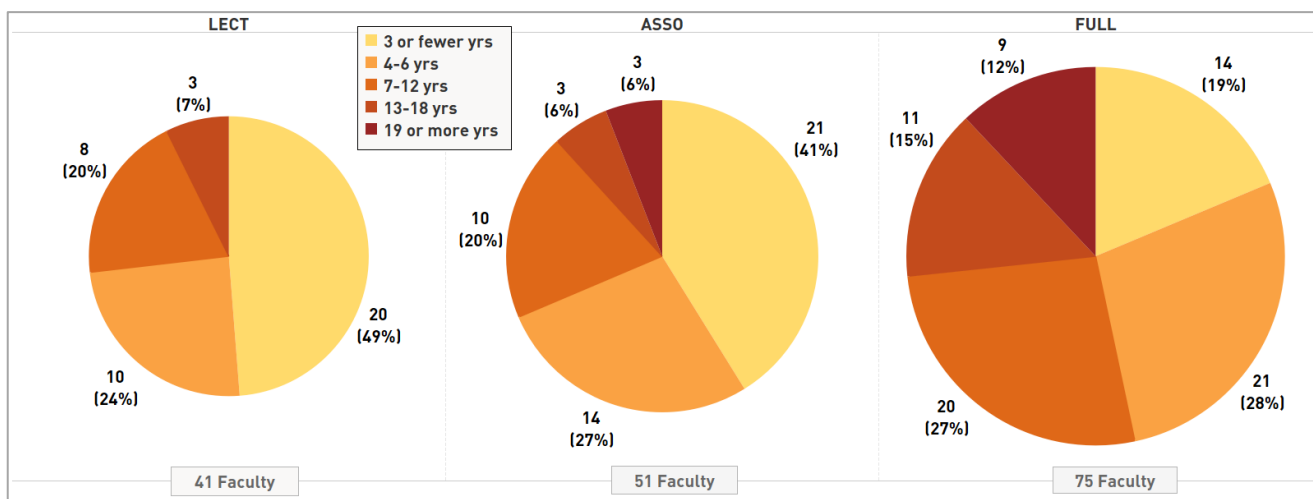


Fig 7. Time in rank of faculty across select ranks.

FACULTY COMPENSATION: STIPENDS, RT & SUMMER SCHOOL

One of the areas that we need to better understand is all the ways that we compensate faculty for the work that they are doing. We ask faculty to do a great deal, particularly with a 24 credit hour teaching commitment. It becomes extraordinarily challenging to engage in meaningful work outside of teaching with this load, and that includes service to the institution, research, extra requests to participate in recruitment efforts, work on advancement efforts, and a host of other opportunities. And yet, despite the challenges, our faculty still manage to engage in this kind of work.

In most cases, capacity is created through some combination of release time from teaching duties—Reassigned Time (RT)—and/or financial support. What we have not been doing well is organizing our understanding of that RT in ways that give us easy insight into who is receiving those benefits, and how much we are resourcing there. The next few displays are a *first pass* at understanding this situation.

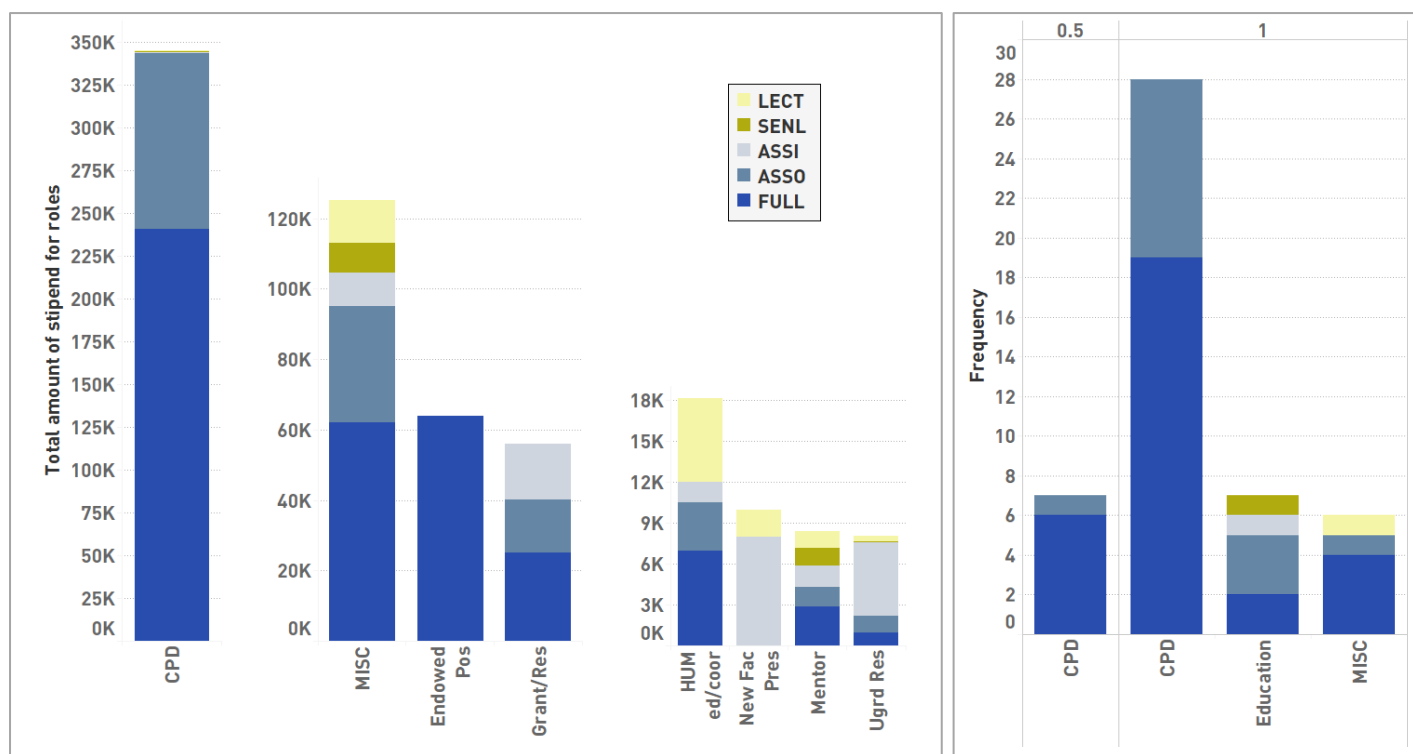


Fig 8. On the left is the total stipends paid out for the various categories of roles. The categories include: Chairs and Program Directors (CPD), which includes the traditional department chairs and program directors, but also the HUM Program Director, the Undergraduate Research Director, and similar positions; miscellaneous stipends; endowed professors and chairs; most of the grants and research funded work; HUM editors and coordinators; new faculty presentation stipends; mentor stipends; and undergraduate research paper reviewing.

On the right is the number of 1/2-months and full-months granted (and paid) to faculty as part of a particular role. The 1/2-months represent times when two faculty share the chair or program director role and the additional month of compensation.

We note that some of these roles are funded by outside sources, including endowed positions, everything in the grant/res category, but also some of the positions in other categories. The faculty mentors for the McCullough Fellowship, for example, are included in the mentor category, but are funded from non-state appropriated funds. There may be a few roles in MISC or other categories that some grant or other funds support. Future reports may include more information about the funding sources of these stipends.

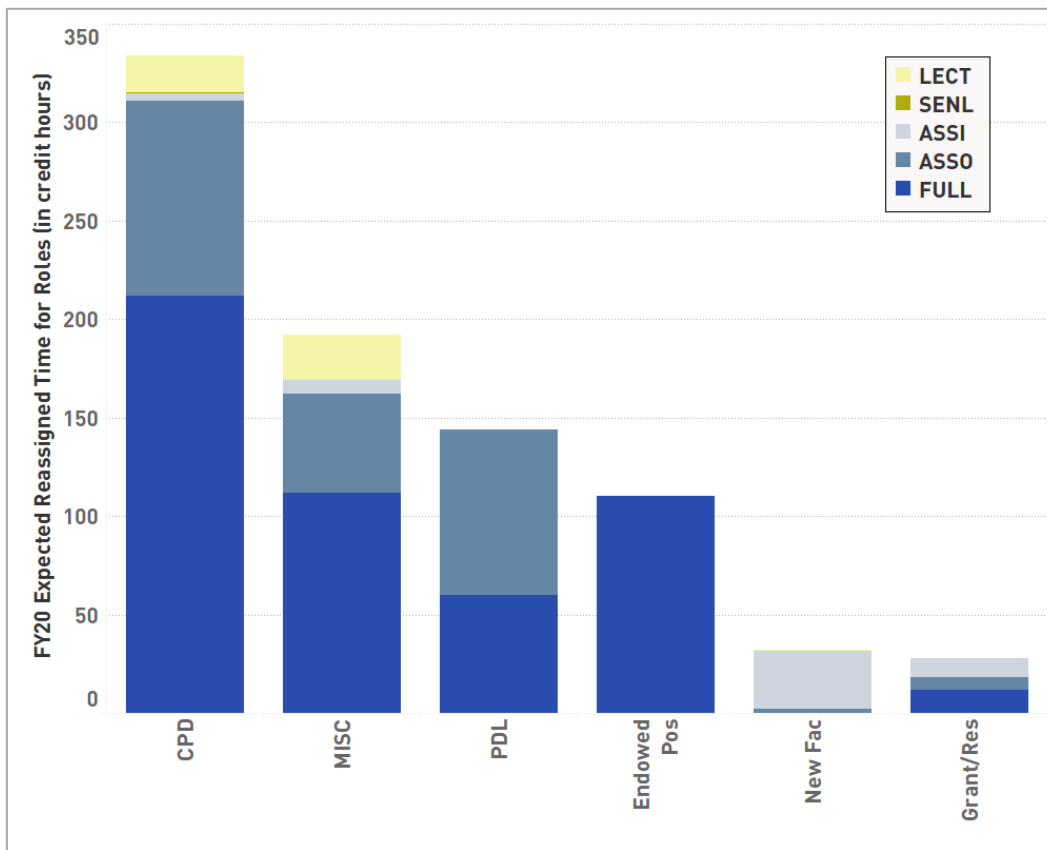


Fig 9. The total number of student credit hours of RT we expect to give, by rank, in FY20. (A total of approximately 35 FTE.) Note that this is not the actual reassigned time taken, but rather **what was expected** based on our best understanding of the arrangements made for each of the positions in these various categories.

UNCA Faculty also teach during the summer. This is an area in which, hopefully, both the institution and the faculty benefit financially.

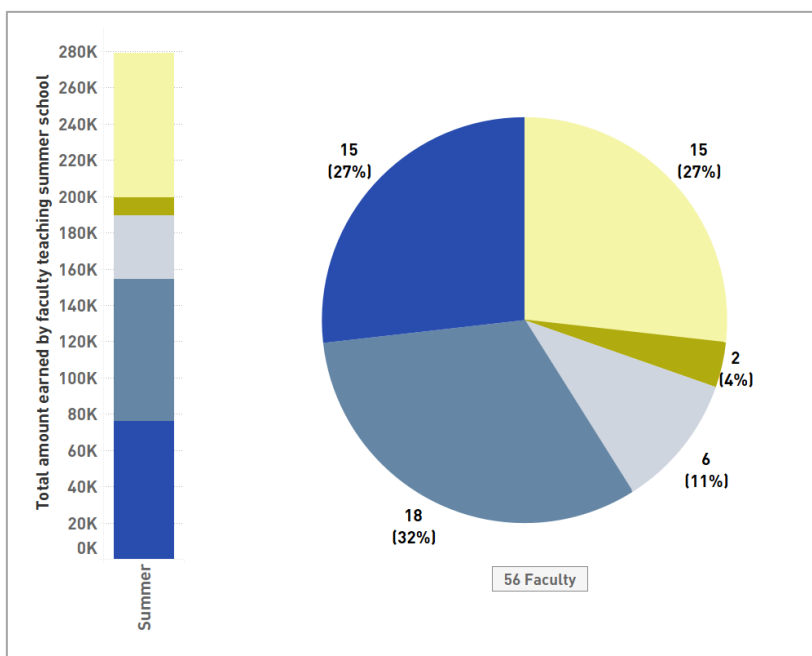


Fig 10. Summer School earnings and number of faculty participating, by rank.

FACULTY TEACHING: CREDIT HOURS, SCH & DISTRIBUTION

We return now to the idea of teaching FTEs. Counting teaching is made complicated by the ways in which some disciplines measure the “teaching credit” a faculty member receives for a course. The total teaching credit that a faculty member receives in a semester can be distinct from the sum of the credit hours earned by students across all courses taught by a faculty member in a given semester (the value used here), and it can be different from the contact hours taught by a faculty member.

In the graph below, for example, it appears as though one faculty member is teaching 105 credit hours. This is not the case. Rather, that is someone who is teaching a single course where one or more students are signed up as taking the course with specialty 1; another group is signed up having specialty 2; and so on. In an overly simplified version of this, consider a situation where a 4 credit hour course has 25 students signed up individually. This would appear below as 100 credit hours worth of teaching, even though the faculty member would only get 4 credit hours of “teaching credit” in this case.

Similarly, there are courses—most notably, *some* labs—where faculty teaching credit is not accurate in a different way. In some labs, students only earn 1 credit, but faculty get teaching credit equivalent to a 3 credit hour course. In addition to the example above and the discrepancies in some labs, there are undoubtedly other situations where calculating the “teaching credit” assigned to faculty for a semester is distinct from summing the credit hours of all the courses taught by a faculty member. One of the things that I am hoping we will do is determine a much improved way to accurately capture “teaching credit” so that we can better report on that value over time. The graphs below do not take such distinctions into account. Reported here is the sum of credit hours taught Fall 2019 by each faculty member, as earned by students taking those courses.

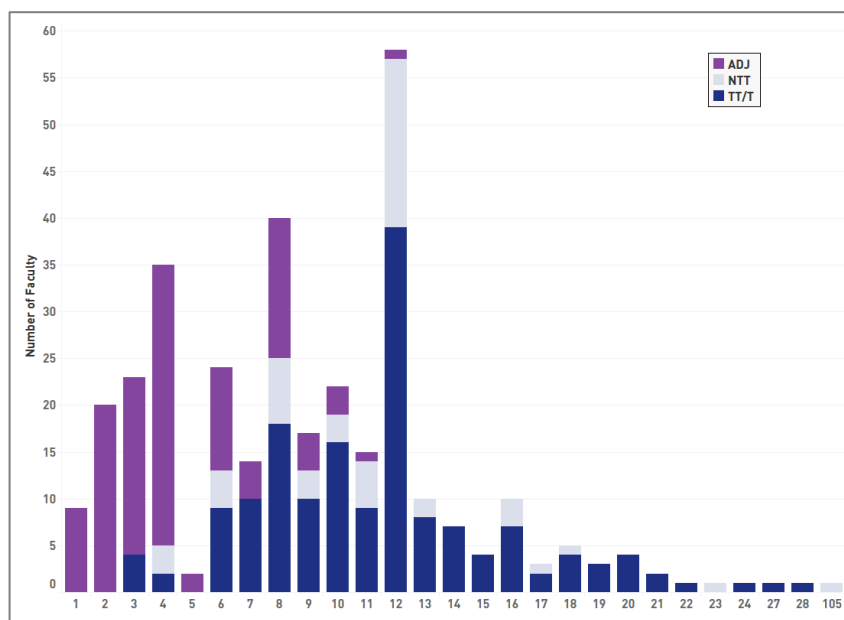


Fig 11. Credit hours taught by faculty, Fall 2019, by “faculty type” (tenure and adjunct status).

In addition to improving the tracking of “courses,” it has also been noted that we will need to improve the ways that we track other forms of labor as well. Labor that is given in exchange for a stipend or reassigned time does appear in the above, but there is, of course, very important work that is done that does not receive either. One example that has been cited is the supervision of undergraduate research or other forms of independent study and one-on-one experiential learning engagements (times when faculty work with a single or very small number of students on a project of some kind). In some cases, there is an accounting of this work, and in other cases, there is none.

Two of the major questions raised by looking at this data are *do we have the right stipend associated with the right work* and *are we distributing the work and these stipends in a way that is equitable?* On the matter of the first: not all service has an associated stipend or gets reassigned time, nor should it. Are we happy with what gets a stipend or reassigned time? Do the amounts of each match the work and expectations? And regarding the latter question: we know that some work being done is “invisible” in the sense that it may not be getting captured or acknowledged in ways that matter; can we improve our ability to capture, understand, and acknowledge that body of work? Who are the faculty getting these stipends or getting reassigned time; are there any systemic biases in who gets them? It is absolutely vital that we answer these questions, and equally importantly, find good ways of recording this information so that we can more easily interrogate and report on it. This is only the first step in that.

Because some of the assessment of faculty time as it relates to teaching is connected to student credit hours (SCH) generated, it is instructive not just to consider number of credit hours offered or contact hours, but also SCH generated. The figure above tries to get at some of these matters and the figure below illustrates the distribution of SCH generated across departments and by rank of faculty.

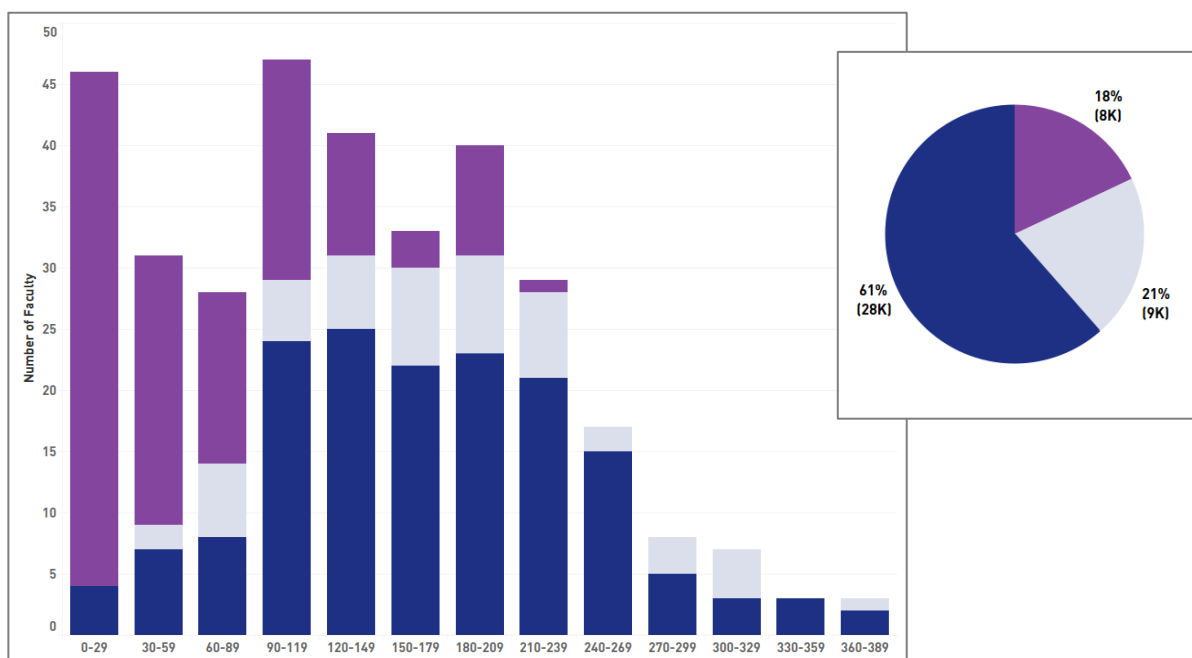


Fig 12. SCH generated by faculty, Fall 2019, by faculty type.

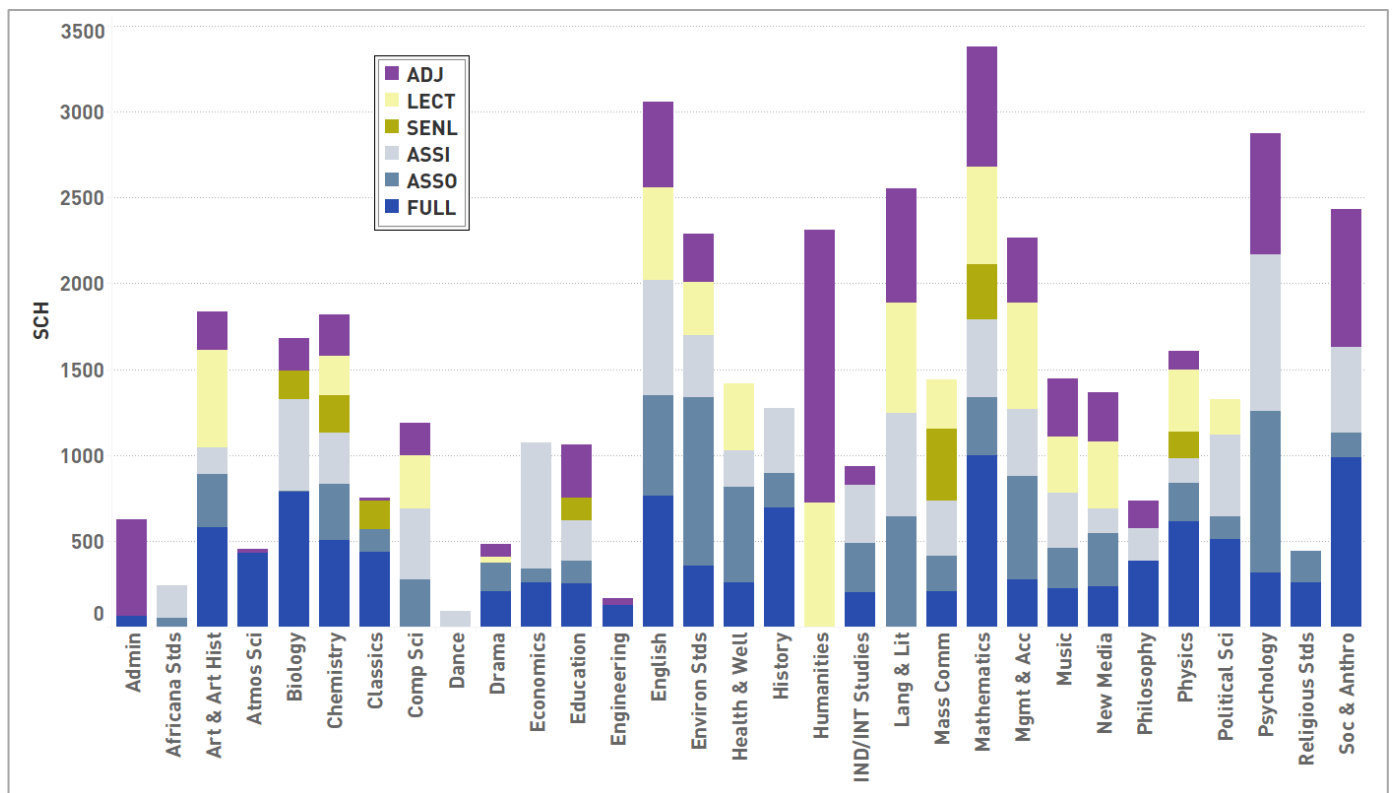


Fig 13. Student Credit Hours (SCH) by home department and rank of faculty (Fall 2019 only).

We conclude with three slides of data on how various disciplinary elements are being taught. The graphs all have the same structure demonstrating distribution of SCHs generated by department and by rank. We include courses from the HUM program, courses that are designated Diversity Intensive, and courses from First Year Seminars. All results are from Fall 2019.

Note that in the above graph and subsequent graphs, there is a “department” labeled as *Admin*. These are the course taught by staff in administrative positions or who have a position in an office that is not an academic department. These include those staff who hold positions in the Advancement Office, Advising and Learning Support Center, North Carolina Center for Health and Wellness, Office of Sustainability, Provost’s Office, STEAM Studio, Student Health and Counseling Office, and Writing Center.

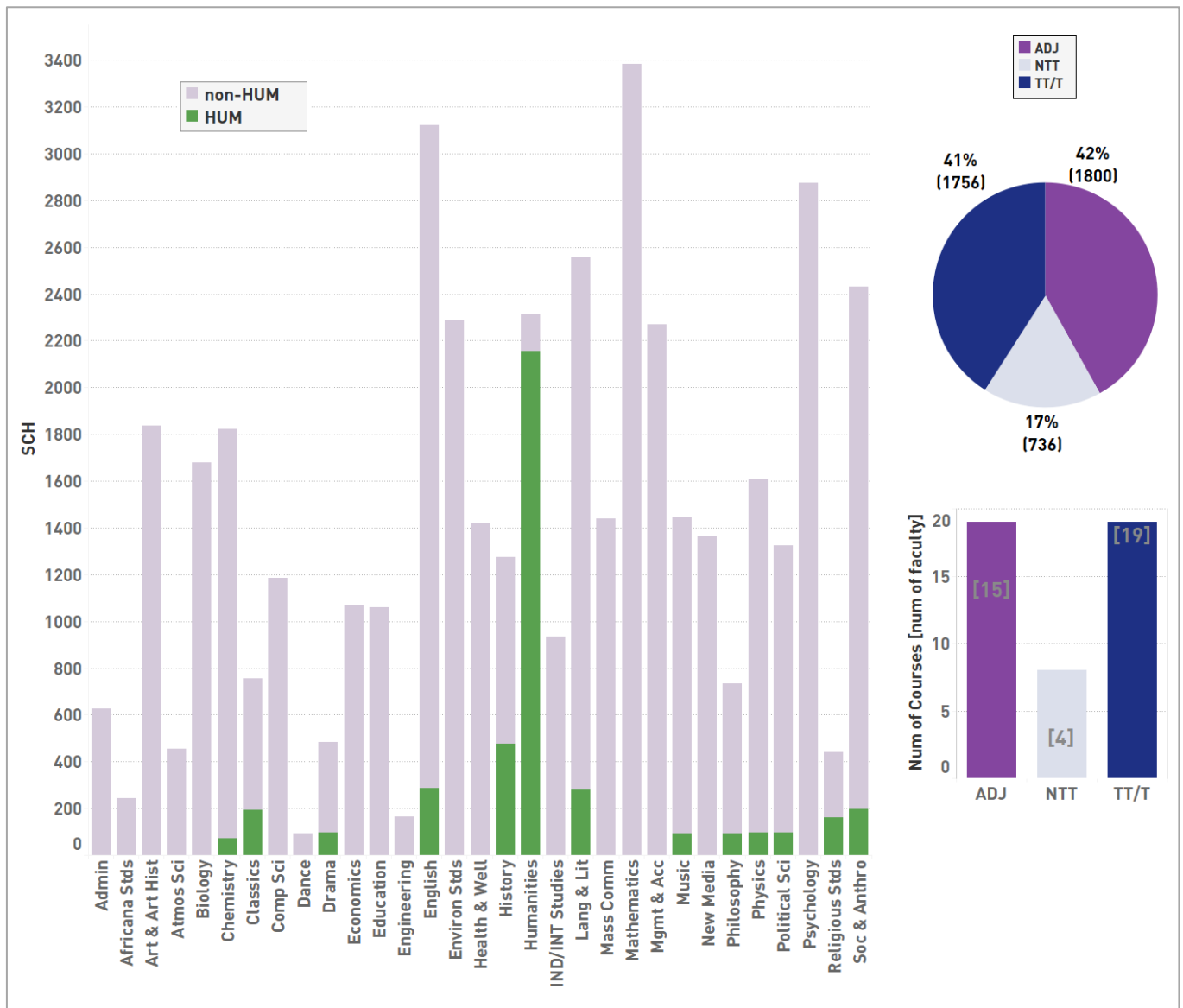


Fig 14. Student Credit Hours (SCH) of Humanities Program, by department and by type of faculty (Fall 2019 only) and the number of HUM courses (and number of faculty teaching those courses). So, there are 15 adjuncts teaching 19 of the HUM courses, generating 1800 SCHs; 4 lecturers teaching 8 HUM courses, generating 736 SCH; and finally, 19 tenure track or tenured faculty teaching 19 HUM courses, generating 1756 SCHs, in Fall 2019 .

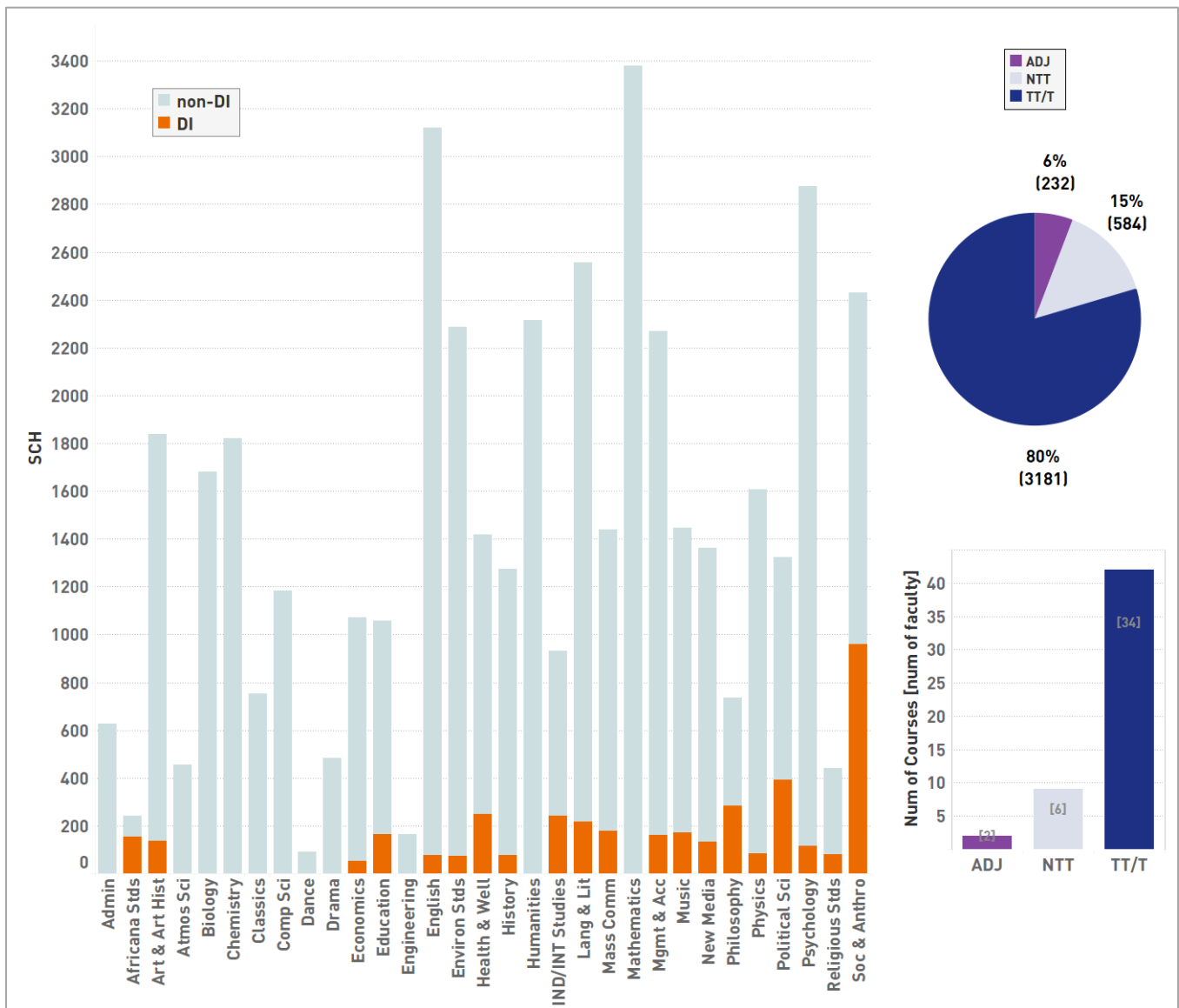


Fig 15. Student Credit Hours (SCH) of Diversity Intensive (DI) Courses, by department and by type of faculty (Fall 2019 only) and the number of DI courses (and number of faculty teaching those courses).

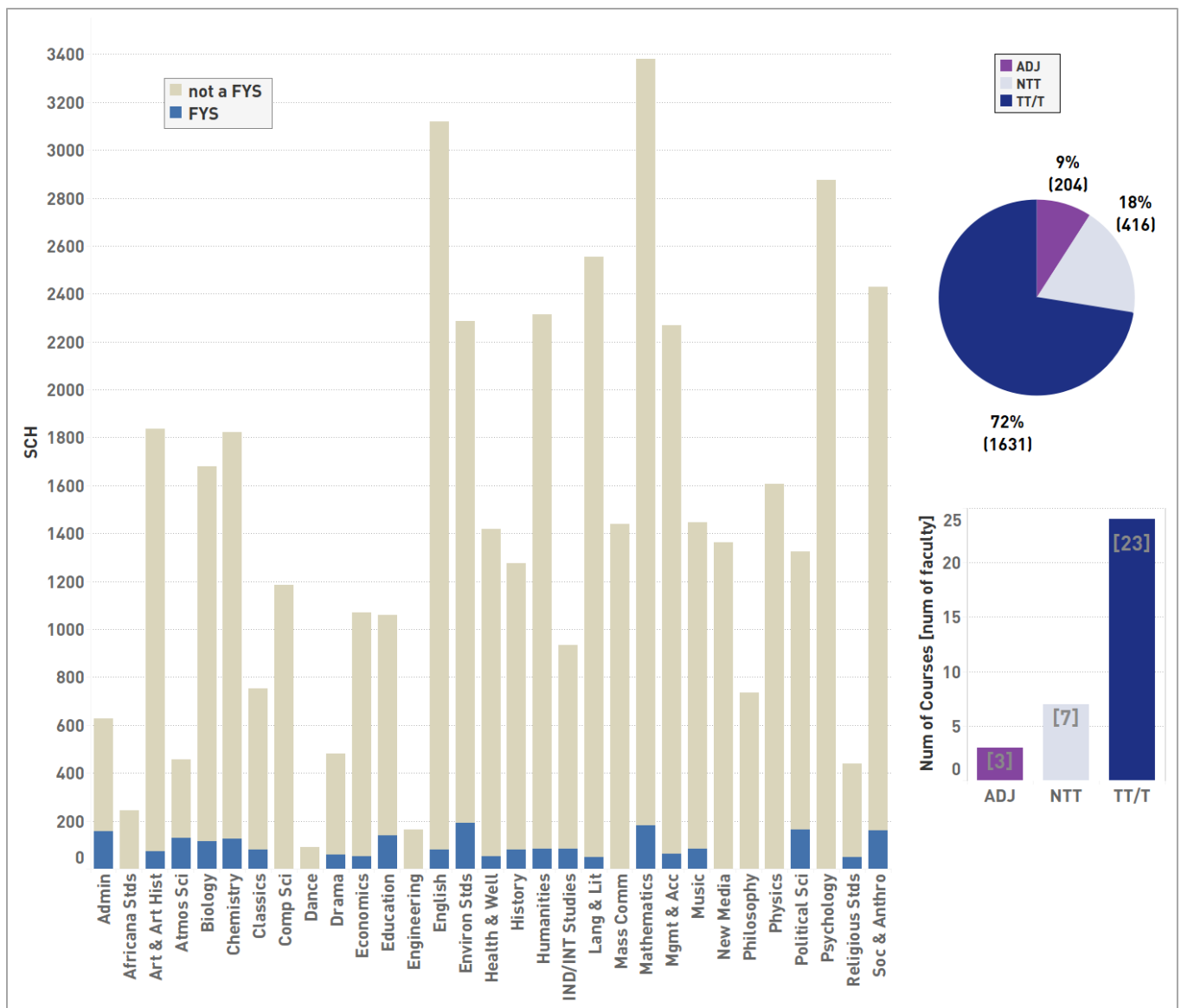


Fig 16. Student Credit Hours (SCH) of First Year Seminar (FYS) Courses, by department and by type of faculty (Fall 2019 only) and the number of FYS courses (and number of faculty teaching those courses).